▼ GLASSHOUSE



THE GREAT CLEANSING

Is there a difference between party and principle? It was the general secretary of BJP's ideological fountainhead RSS, Dattatreya Hosabale, who stirred the pot with his demand for removing the words 'socialist' and 'secular' from the Preamble of the Constitution. But Vice-President Jagdeep Dhankhar, Union ministers Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Jitendra Singh as well as Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma have also been voicing similar sentiments, asking for a "cleansing" of what they see as insertions imposed during the Emergency. The catch? The BJP's own constitution pledges allegiance to "the principles of socialism, secularism and democracy". So, a Congress wag asks: will the BJP amend its own constitution before demanding changes in the one Ambedkar drafted and Indira Gandhi amended?

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ FOOT NOTE

IN PA'S FOOTSTEPS



Bihar chief minister **Nitish Kumar** was once known for jokingly diving for officers' feet to get work done, saying, "*Kahiye to aapke payr chhu loon*." Son **Nishant Kumar** did the same on June 28 as he respectfully tried to touch Patna DM Thiyagarajan S.M.'s feet during an official event in Bakhtiyarpur. The officer, caught off-guard, quickly held Nishant's hands to stop him, as cameras captured the moment. Kumar Jr's political plans are still unclear, but the gesture may have struck the right chord with the public. In an election year, a touch of humility, real or rehearsed, never hurts.